November 8, 2026

The Editor-in-Chief
SN Computer Science
Springer Nature

Dear Editor,

We submit our manuscript *"Reliable Smartphone-Based Detection of Counterfeit Bangladeshi Banknotes: Multi-View Deep Learning with Out-of-Distribution Rejection and a Benchmark Audit"* for consideration as an original research article in *SN Computer Science*.

JaalTaka is the public benchmark for detecting counterfeit Bangladeshi Tk 500 and Tk 1000 notes, and published CNNs report 97–99% accuracy on it. Our study asks whether this accuracy measures counterfeit recognition at all. The main findings are:

- A duplicate audit, to our knowledge the first for a counterfeit-banknote benchmark, shows that the 1,390 notes form only 846 distinct photograph sets, that 116 of 208 test notes have a copy in training or validation, and that 12 duplicate groups carry both labels and explain every test error.
- On a group-aware split without shared photographs, both our fine-tuned model and nearest-neighbour classification on generic ImageNet features classify all 205 test notes correctly, and an occlusion test shows that the image border alone separates the classes. The benchmark is therefore saturated and cannot rank methods.
- An open, CPU-real-time smartphone pipeline (37 ms per photograph) adds multi-view fusion, a three-way decision with an "uncertain" outcome, an out-of-distribution gate, and Grad-CAM explanations, evaluated with group-level bootstrap intervals and paired McNemar tests.

We think the work suits the journal's readership in applied machine learning and computer vision. It combines a practical system with a reproducible analysis of evaluation pitfalls (data leakage, label noise, and shortcut learning) that apply to many small image benchmarks. The duplicate groups, split assignments, test predictions, and all analysis code are provided as Online Resource 1.

We confirm that this manuscript is original, has not been published elsewhere, and is not under consideration by any other journal. Both authors have approved the manuscript and agree with its submission. The authors declare no competing interests, and the study received no external funding. The study uses only a public CC BY 4.0 dataset and involves no human participants or animals.

Thank you for considering our manuscript.

Sincerely,

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